

Observe. Compare. Make a choice.

CTIN 290 · Monday September 21 · 10 AM-12:50 PM · SCI L104

What does the camera help you notice, and what does it keep you from choosing to watch?

Watch and test · 10:00-11:30

Start with the sound-and-action lab. The strike stays the same; does the sound arrive before, with, or after contact?

Hamilton: the official trailer at 10:12. Watch, inspect 0:14-0:17, then pause at 0:15. Describe the arrangement and what the frame lets you see. The trailer does not establish what happens throughout the full production.

Critical Role at 10:24: watch 7:28-8:38. Inspect hands at 7:38; compare the speaker at 8:28 with the listener at 8:33. A short excerpt can suggest a character choice; more moments are needed to establish a recurring habit.

Three tools for the comparison

Blocking

Positions, paths, distance, and facing. Stillness can be a deliberate arrangement.

Gesturality

Bodily gestures contribute to expressive meaning. Name the action before inferring what it means.

Reaction shot

A view emphasizes someone's response. The reaction belongs to the performance; showing it is a framing or editing choice.

10:36-11:16: test the three experiments, then propose a camera choice for a game. Ask another pair what they noticed before explaining your intention.

11:16-11:30: rehearse one claim for your existing video essay. Compare the same story/world in two media, using your chosen adaptation pair.

Break · 11:30-11:40

Take the full ten minutes. Return with your mood-board team.

Your team's visual world

The existing brief: a game involving collaboration.

Final board: 20-40 images establishing visual language, tone, color palette, and world. Five-minute team presentation; everyone speaks.

11:40-11:50 • Brief and examples

Open your existing shared board. Look at the three worked examples, then agree on one visual decision your own team will work on.

11:50-12:20 • 30 uninterrupted minutes

Work on the board you will actually submit. Choose or revise a coherent set of references, explain why they belong, and keep one unresolved choice for feedback. These are progress suggestions, not a new submission.

12:20-12:35 • Team-to-team feedback

I Like: a specific strength. I Wish: a named gap. What If: a possibility to test. Point to the visual choices behind your reading.

12:35-12:45 • Revise and save

Make one useful change. Agree who does what next and confirm everyone can access the board.

The four existing rubric criteria

Visual Cohesion • Curation & Justification • Color & Palette Development • Presentation & Accessibility. Five points each.

12:45-12:50 • Exit

One choice I can now point to is _____. One question I want to test next is _____. Download a copy of your local notes. No new hand-in today.

Dates to keep

Video essay: September 24, 5 PM Pacific. Mood-board file: October 1, 5 PM Pacific. Team presentations: October 5.

[Open the mood-board studio](#)

[Digital notes](#)

[Viewing cues](#)

[Video-essay assignment and rubric](#)